

Phosphorus

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This element's name means "giver of light" in Greek. There are different types of phosphorus. Its white form is the most reactive and catches fire as soon as it comes into contact with air. White phosphorus is poisonous, and in certain conditions, it glows in the dark.

ATOMIC MASS 30.974

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1669 (Hennig Brandt)

Purple crystals of
apatite, an ore
of phosphorus,
in rock



Arsenic

Almost every form of this semi-metal, pure or in compounds, is poisonous to living things. Because of this, arsenic has long been used as a poison for controlling rats. It is also used as a component in microchips.

